The Documentation Formatter

RSpec's built-in *documentation formatter* lists the specs' output in an outline format, using indentation to show grouping. If you've written example descriptions with legible output in mind, the result will read almost like project documentation. Let's give it a try.

To see the output in documentation format, pass --format documentation (or just -f d) to rspec:

```
$ rspec --format documentation

A cup of coffee
  costs $1
  with milk
    costs $1.25 (FAILED - 1)

Failures:

  1) A cup of coffee with milk costs $1.25
     Failure/Error: expect(coffee.price).to eq(1.25)

       expected: 1.25
            got: 1.0

       (compared using ==)
     # ./spec/coffee_spec.rb:26:in `block (3 levels) in <top (required)>'

Finished in 0.01073 seconds (files took 0.08736 seconds to load)
2 examples, 1 failure

Failed examples:

rspec ./spec/coffee_spec.rb:25 # A cup of coffee with milk costs $1.25
```

The test report is a list of the specifications of various cups of coffee that RSpec verified. There's a lot of information here, and RSpec uses spacing and capitalization to show you what's going on:

- An example group lists all of its examples indented underneath it.
- Contexts create additional nesting, the way the with milk example is indented further.
- Any failing examples show the text FAILED with a footnote number for looking up the details later on.

After the documentation at the top of the report, the Failures section shows the following details for each failure:

- The expectation that failed
- What result you expected versus what actually happened
- The file and line number of the failing expectation